gotourney

Tournament Director's Guide – running a TGoR Go tournament with the command line tools
Version 0.2 · November 2026

This guide describes the whole tournament, from registration to the EGD upload. All features described here are available in version 0.2.

---

1. The tournament format
2. Overview of the workflow
3. Installation
4. Setting up a tournament
5. Registering players
6. Pairing a round
7. Entering results and standings
8. The wall list and the EGD upload
9. How the ratings are calculated
10. Editing files by hand
11. Troubleshooting
12. Command reference

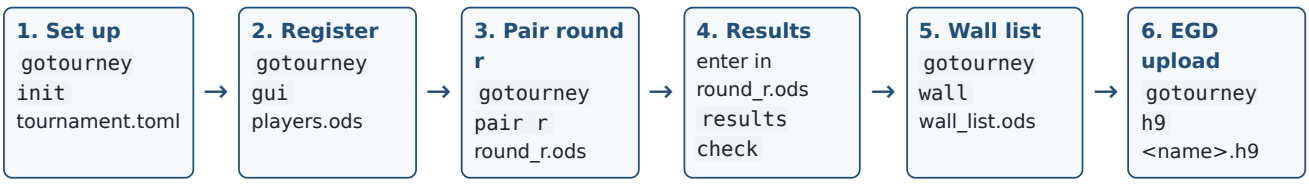
1. The tournament format

Instead of McMahon scores, every player has a **tournament rating (TGoR)**:

- **Start:** the TGoR starts at the player's current EGD GoR on registration day. Players without a GoR start at the value of their declared rank (1k = 2000, 1d = 2100, 100 points per rank). The director may correct a starting GoR, for example when it is clearly outdated.
- **After every round**, all TGoRs are updated with the EGD rating formula, with two changes. The formula's `con` factor is multiplied by the tournament's **k-factor**, so ratings move faster than in the EGD. The EGD's anti-deflation bonus is not used. All games of a round are rated from the TGoRs *before* that round.
- **Pairing:** players are paired so that the TGoR differences are as small as possible, using the blossom algorithm. Two players never meet twice through automatic pairing, and pairs from the same club are avoided where possible.
- **Handicap:** games are played with **full handicap** by default, one stone per 100 TGoR points of difference. A reduction ("full minus N") can be set. Players may agree on a different handicap for their game.
- **Winner:** the player with the highest final TGoR wins. If two players have the same final TGoR, the one with the *lower* starting GoR ranks higher. If that is also equal, a random draw decides.

2. Overview of the workflow

Each step reads and writes LibreOffice Calc files (`.ods`). You can open, check and change them by hand between the steps. The files are the only record of the tournament: there is no hidden database.



Steps 3 and 4 are repeated for every round.

All files of one tournament live in one folder:

```
my_tournament/
  tournament.toml     settings                                    (step 1)
  players.ods         registered players                           (step 2)
  round_1.ods         pairing of round 1; results are entered here (steps 3, 4)
  round_2.ods         ...
  standings.ods       TGoR after each round                        (step 4)
  wall_list.ods       final wall list, editable                    (step 5)
  <name>.h9           result file for the EGD                      (step 6)
```

All commands take the option `-d <folder>` to choose the tournament folder. Without it, the current folder is used. So you can either `cd my_tournament` once, or add `-d my_tournament` to every command.

3. Installation AVAILABLE

The tools need Python 3.11 or newer. On Ubuntu also install `python3-venv` and `python3-tk` (the latter for the registration window):

```
sudo apt install python3-venv python3-tk
cd ~/Go/TournamentOrgaTool
python3 -m venv .venv
.venv/bin/pip install -e '.[test]'
source .venv/bin/activate        # afterwards 'gotourney' is available in this terminal
gotourney --help
```

Alternatively, `pipx install -e ~/Go/TournamentOrgaTool` makes `gotourney` available in every terminal without activating anything.

4. Setting up a tournament AVAILABLE

```
gotourney init my_tournament --name "21. Schweriner Drachenschlacht" --rounds 5
```

This creates the folder with `tournament.toml` and an empty `players.ods`. Open `tournament.toml` in a text editor and fill in the settings **before** registering players:

Setting	Example	Meaning
[tournament] – EGD metadata, written to the header of the .h9 file		
`code`	`""`	EGD tournament code. Leave empty: the EGD assigns it after the upload.
`name`	"21. Schweriner..."	Tournament name (EV).
`place`	"DE, Schwerin"	Country and city (PC).
`dates`	["2026-09-26", "2026-09-27"]	First and last day (DT).
`class`	"A"	EGD tournament class (CL).
`time`	75	Basic thinking time in minutes (TM).
`comment`	"(submitted by ...)"	Comment (CM).
`rounds`	5	Number of rounds (also `init --rounds`).
[rating]		
`k_factor`	3.0	Multiplies the EGD `con` factor. Higher values make ratings move faster during the tournament.
[handicap]		
`reduction`	0	"Full minus N" handicap. Written to the .h9 as `HA[h<N>]`: h0 = full handicap, h2 = reduced by 2 stones, h9 = no handicap.
`komi_even`	6.5	Komi in even games: 6.5, 7 or 7.5 (Chinese rules).
`komi_handicap`	0.5	Komi in handicap games.
[pairing]		
`club_penalty`	150	Pairs from the same club are treated as if their TGoR difference were this many points larger, so the pairing avoids them where possible.
`random_seed`	12345	Seed for random decisions (colours, choosing a joker, final tie-breaks). The same seed always gives the same result.

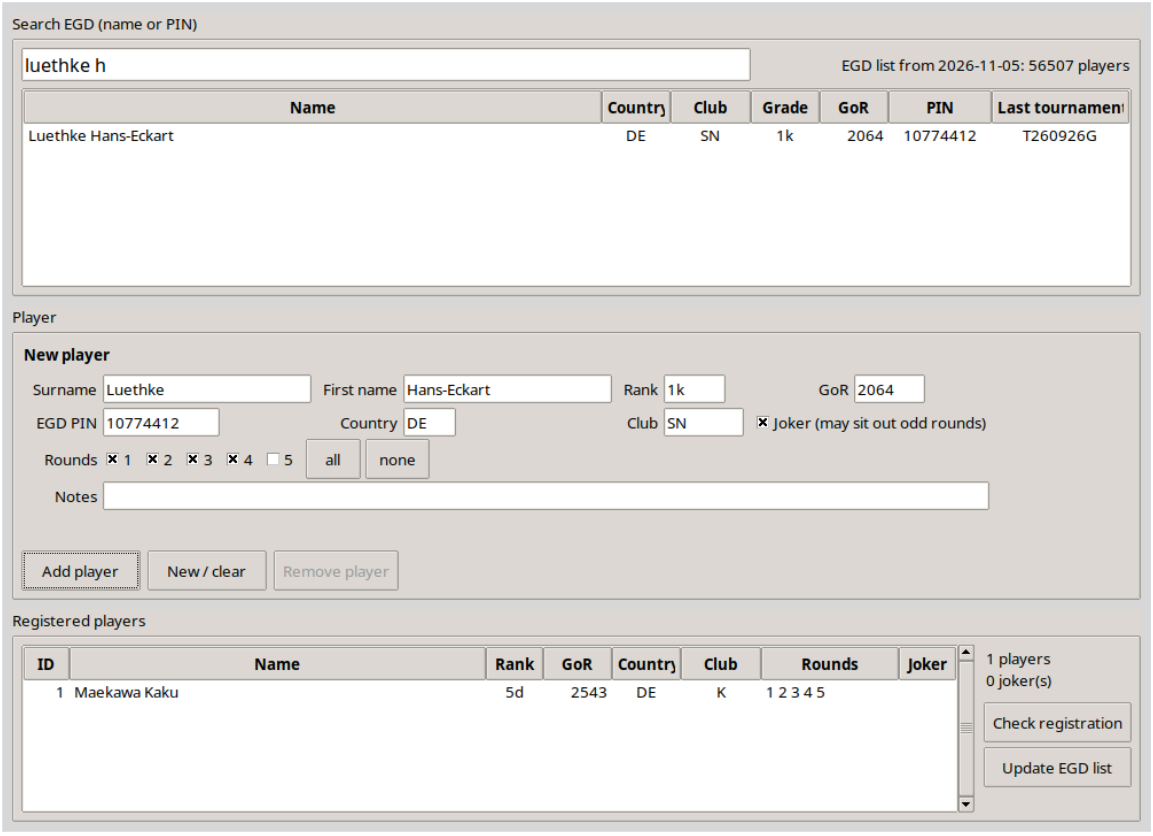
Setting	Example	Meaning
[registration]		
`gor_outdated_years`	5	Warn if a player's last EGD tournament is older than this.
`rank_gor_tolerance`	300	Warn if declared rank and GoR differ by more than this.

> Invalid settings are reported with the setting's name, for example `handicap.komi_even must be one of 6.5, 7.0, 7.5`. You can change settings later, including `rounds`. New rounds count as played by all registered players until you change that in `players.ods`. Columns of removed rounds are ignored and disappear the next time `players.ods` is written.

5. Registering players

5.1 The registration window AVAILABLE

```
gotourney gui -d my_tournament
```



The registration window: EGD search (top), player form (middle), registered players (bottom).

1. **Search:** type part of the name in the search field. Name parts can be in any order ("*erik broek*" finds *van den Broek Erik*) and umlaut spellings are treated alike ("*Lüthke*" finds *Luethke*). Typing digits searches by EGD PIN. Players who are already registered are marked *(registered)*.
2. **Choose a player:** press ↓ and **Enter**, or double-click. **Enter** in the search field takes the first match. The form is filled with name, rank, GoR, PIN, country and club. The window then fetches the player's latest data live from the EGD and updates the GoR if it changed.
3. **Check and complete the form:** untick rounds the player will not play, tick **Joker** if the player may sit out odd rounds, and add notes. Hints in orange appear under the form for:
   - a PIN that is already registered;
   - a rank and GoR that differ by more than `rank_gor_tolerance`;
   - a last EGD tournament older than `gor_outdated_years`, meaning the GoR may be outdated. Correct the GoR field if needed.
4. **Add player** (or Enter in a form field) writes the player to `players.ods` immediately.

- **Players who are not in the EGD:** type their data into the form without searching. A rank is enough: the GoR is then taken from the rank.
- **Editing:** click a player in the bottom table. The form switches to *Edit ID n*. Use **Save changes** or **Remove player**. **New / clear** goes back to adding.
- **Check registration** runs the registration check (see 5.4).
- **Update EGD list** downloads a fresh copy of the EGD player list.

> **The EGD player list.** Searching uses a local copy of the complete EGD player list (about 56,500 players). It is stored in `~/.cache/gotourney/` and downloaded again when it is more than a day old. If there is no internet at the venue, the last downloaded list is used. Run `gotourney egd update` the evening before the tournament to be safe.

5.2 Registering on the command line AVAILABLE

```
gotourney players add --pin 10774412                      # everything else from the EGD
gotourney players add --pin 20633162 --gor 2500 --rounds 1-3
gotourney players add Doe John --rank 5k --club HH --country DE --joker
gotourney players list
gotourney egd search "luethke h"                          # find a PIN
```

Options of `players add`: `--rank`, `--gor`, `--pin`, `--country`, `--club`, `--rounds` (`all`, `none`, `1,2,4`, `1-3`), `--joker`, `--notes`. Values you give explicitly win over the EGD data.

5.3 The file players.ods AVAILABLE

Column	Meaning
ID	Running number. It identifies the player in the round files. Never change or reuse it.
Surname, First name	As in the EGD.
Rank	Declared rank (`5k`, `1d`, ...).
GoR	**Starting TGoR.** Filled from the EGD, or from the rank. You may overwrite it.
EGD PIN, Country, Club	EGD data. Club is used for the club penalty in the pairing.
Joker	`x` = may sit out rounds with an odd number of players.
R1 ... Rn	`x` = plays this round. Empty = does not play.
EGD GoR, Last EGD tournament	Information only: the GoR and last tournament in the EGD on registration day.
Notes	Free text.

Players who arrive late, leave early or skip a round: change their round columns. A player who does not play a round keeps their TGoR unchanged.

5.4 Checking the registration AVAILABLE

```
gotourney players check
```

Problems are reported at three levels:

- **Errors** must be fixed before pairing:
  - the same PIN registered twice;
  - a player with neither GoR nor rank;
  - a round with an odd number of players and no joker. Nominate a joker by marking one of that round's players in the Joker column.
- **Warnings** should be checked: rank and GoR far apart, GoR possibly outdated, a player registered for no round, two players with the same name.
- **Info** is for your knowledge only, for example which jokers can sit out in odd rounds.

The command ends with an error status if there are errors, so it can also be used in scripts.

5.5 Refreshing EGD data AVAILABLE

```
gotourney players sync              # live from the EGD
gotourney players sync --offline    # only the downloaded player list
```

Fetches the current EGD data for all registered players and reports what changed: name, country, club, EGD GoR and last tournament. The declared rank is never changed. The GoR column (starting TGoR) is only filled when it is empty, so your corrections are never overwritten. Once round 1 has been paired, the starting GoRs are frozen.

6. Pairing a round AVAILABLE

6.1 Workflow

1. **Optional – manual pairings first.** If you want to fix certain games yourself (for example a rematch, or players who must play early), run `gotourney pair 3 --template`. It creates an empty `round_3.ods`. Enter those boards with the two player IDs and mark them `x` in the *Manual* column. The sheet *Participants* lists the players of the round with their TGoR to help you. If you leave **Handicap** empty, the default handicap, komi and colours are filled in (White and Black may be swapped so that the weaker player gets black). If you enter a handicap, your colours and handicap are kept as they are. Manual pairings may be rematches; you get a warning.
2. **Automatic pairing:** `gotourney pair 3` keeps all boards marked `x` in the *Manual* column and pairs all remaining players of round 3. Boards without the mark are paired again, so running `pair` twice gives a fresh pairing.
3. **Check and print** `round_3.ods`. Players may agree on a different handicap; just change the Handicap/Komi cells of that board. The tools always use what is written in the file.

> `gotourney pair` refuses to overwrite a round file that already contains results. Use `--force` only if you really want to pair the round again. A round can only be paired when all results of the previous rounds are entered, and not after a later round exists.

6.2 How the automatic pairing works

- **Participants:** the players with an `x` in this round's column who are not on a manual board.
- **Odd number of players:** one joker sits out, namely the joker with the **most games already played**, chosen at random if tied. If no joker is available, the tool stops and asks you to nominate one.
- **Pair cost:** each possible pair gets the cost `(|TGoR difference| + club_penalty if same club)²`. Pairs who already played each other in this tournament, including forfeited games, are excluded.
- **Optimal pairing:** the blossom algorithm (maximum weight matching) chooses the pairing with the smallest total cost. Squaring the cost prefers several medium differences over a single very uneven pair.
- **No pairing possible:** if rematches make a complete pairing impossible (possible with very few players), the tool stops. Pair the problematic players by hand as manual boards and run it again.

6.3 Handicap, komi and colours

TGoR difference	Full handicap	Game
0 – 50	0	Even game, komi `komi_even`, colours balanced
51 – 150	1	Weaker player takes black, no stones, komi `komi_handicap`
151 – 250	2	Weaker player black with 2 stones, komi `komi_handicap`
…	…	…
851 and more	9	Maximum

- The difference is divided by 100 and rounded, with exact halves rounded **down** (150 → 1, 151 → 2).
- With a reduction N, the handicap is `min(full, 9) − N`, but never below 0. In an h2 tournament the default handicap is therefore at most 7. A result of 1 after the reduction is a handicap-1 game, not an even game.
- **Colours in even games** are balanced over the tournament: the player who has had white more often in even games gets black. If both are equal, the colour is drawn at random. Handicap games do not count for the balance.
- **Board order:** board 1 is the pair with the highest TGoR. Manual boards are sorted in as well.

6.4 The round file round_r.ods

Board	White ID	White TGoR	White	White win	Draw	Black win	Black	Black TGoR	Black ID	Handicap	Komi	Manual
1	1	2543	○ 5d Maekawa Kaku	x			● 3d Lewerenz Bernd	2297	3	2	0.5	
2	5	2143	○ 1d Wolff Martin		x		● 1d Moldovan Christian	2158	2	0	6.5	

- The player columns show the colour (○ white, ● black), the registered rank and the name. They are for reading only. The tools identify the players by **White ID** and **Black ID**.
- Black always receives the handicap stones. The TGoR shown is the TGoR before the round.
- The second sheet, *Not playing*, lists the players who sit out the round (joker, not registered).
- The file prints in landscape, scaled to the page width, so a pairing can be printed and posted directly.

7. Entering results and standings

7.1 Results

Enter the result in `round_r.ods` with an **x** in one of the three columns between the player names: **White win**, **Draw** or **Black win**.

White win	Draw	Black win	Meaning	Rating
`x`			White wins	rated
		`x`	Black wins	rated
	`x`		Draw (jigo)	rated, ½ point each
`x!`			White wins by forfeit (`x!` under Black win: Black wins by forfeit)	not rated – as if the game had not taken place (but counts as "played" for the rematch rule)
`!`		`!`	Both lose by forfeit	
			No result yet	–

Upper case `X` and check marks (✓) are accepted as well. Anything else, for example marks in two columns, is reported with the row number.

7.2 Checking results AVAILABLE

```
gotourney results check 3
```

Reports boards without a valid result, players appearing twice, players who are not registered for the round, and (as a warning) rematches.

7.3 Standings AVAILABLE

```
gotourney standings            # all rounds played so far
gotourney standings --round 2  # after round 2
```

Calculates the TGoR of every player after each round and writes `standings.ods`, for checking and for announcing the standings between rounds. TGoRs are calculated with full precision and shown rounded to whole numbers.

8. The wall list and the EGD upload AVAILABLE

8.1 Wall list

```
gotourney wall
```

Calculates the final TGoR and the places, and writes `wall_list.ods`. Places are ordered by final TGoR (rounded), then lower starting GoR, then a random draw. A second sheet, *TGoR history*, shows every player's TGoR after each round. You can still correct the wall list by hand, for example a name spelling. All results must be entered before the wall list can be made.

8.2 EGD result file

```
gotourney h9                      # writes <tournament code or name>.h9
gotourney h9 -o drachenschlacht.h9
```

Generates the result file in the EGD's `.h9` format from `wall_list.ods`, so your hand corrections are included. Send this file to the EGD. Header (TC stays empty, the EGD fills it in):

```
; TC[]
; CL[A]
; EV[21. Schweriner Drachenschlacht]
; PC[DE, Schwerin]
; DT[2026-09-26,2026-09-27]
; HA[h0]
; KM[6.5]
; TM[75]
; CM[(submitted by ...)]
;.
```

One line per player:

```
 1 Maekawa Kaku          5d DE  K     4  2543  2611  5+/b    6+/w    3+/w2   2+/w    4-/w     |20633162
```

- Place, name (spaces inside a name part become `_`, e.g. `van_den_Broek`), rank, country (`XX` if unknown), club (`XXXX` if none). Names are spelled as in the EGD.
- Wins (jigo = ½), starting GoR, final TGoR. There are no McMahon columns.
- One field per round: `opponent's place`, `+` win / `-` loss / `=` jigo, `/w` or `/b` for the colour, then the handicap (omitted if 0). `0=` means not played: joker round, absent, or forfeit.
- `|PIN` at the end. Players without a PIN have nothing there.

9. How the ratings are calculated AVAILABLE

The TGoR update follows the EGF rating system as revised in 2021. For a game between A and B (Black receives *H* handicap stones):

```
h(H)      = 0 if H = 0, otherwise 100 · (H − 0.5)
            (handicap 1 is worth 50 points, 2 stones 150, 3 stones 250, ...)
β(r)      = −7 · ln(3300 − r − h)
            (h only for the player who receives the stones)
SE_A      = 1 / (1 + exp(β_B − β_A))              expected score of A
con(r)    = ((3300 − r) / 200) ^ 1.6
r_A'      = r_A + k_factor · con(r_A) · (S_A − SE_A)
            S = 1 win, ½ jigo, 0 loss; never below −900;
            the EGD bonus term is not used; komi does not enter the formula
```

Example with `k_factor = 3`. In the EGD (k = 1) the changes would be a third of these.

Game	Expected score of White	Result	Change White	Change Black
White 2000 – Black 1900, even	0.63	White wins	+22.4	−25.2

Game	Expected score of White	Result	Change White	Change Black
White 2000 – Black 1900, even	0.63	Black wins	−37.6	+42.3
White 2000 – Black 1750, 2 stones	0.63	Black wins	−37.6	+49.8

The 2 stones are worth 150 points, so the 250-point game in the last row is rated like a 100-point even game. Lower-rated players have a larger `con` and gain or lose more points per game. The formula was checked against the reference values of an independent implementation of the EGF system.

10. Editing files by hand

- Open the `.ods` files in LibreOffice Calc, change what you need, **save in .ods format** and **close the file**.
- Keep the header row. You may add your own columns (they are ignored), reorder columns, or change formatting. Formatting is lost when a tool rewrites the file.
- **Close the file before running a command that writes it.** The tools refuse to write a file that is open in LibreOffice, because one of the two versions would otherwise be lost.
- Never change a player's **ID** once rounds have been paired. Round files refer to players by ID.
- The registration window notices when `players.ods` changes on disk and reloads it within two seconds.
- Error messages name the file and row, for example `players.ods, row 7: invalid rank 'xx'`.

11. Troubleshooting

Message / problem	What to do
`… is open in LibreOffice`	Save and close the file in LibreOffice, then run the command again. If LibreOffice crashed, delete the leftover lock file `.~lock.players.ods#` in the tournament folder.
`tournament.toml not found`	You are not in the tournament folder. Use `-d <folder>` or `cd` into it.
`round r: … players (odd) and no joker`	Mark a player of that round as joker, or change who plays that round.
EGD list not available	No internet and no downloaded list yet. Register players by typing their data, and run `gotourney egd update` when online.
`externally-managed-environment` when installing	Install into the project's virtual environment (`.venv/bin/pip`), see section 3. Do not use `--break-system-packages`.
Wrong result in an earlier round	Correct it in that `round_r.ods`. Standings and wall list are always recalculated from all round files. Rounds that are already paired keep their pairing.

12. Command reference

Command	Purpose	Status
`gotourney init <dir> [--name] [--rounds]`	Create a tournament folder	AVAILABLE
`gotourney gui [--update-list]`	Registration window with EGD autocomplete	AVAILABLE
`gotourney players add …`	Register a player (with `--pin`: data from the EGD)	AVAILABLE
`gotourney players list`	Show registered players	AVAILABLE
`gotourney players check`	Check the registration	AVAILABLE
`gotourney players sync [--offline]`	Refresh EGD data of registered players	AVAILABLE
`gotourney egd update`	Download the EGD player list	AVAILABLE
`gotourney egd search <query>`	Search the EGD player list	AVAILABLE
`gotourney pair <r> [--template] [--force]`	Pair round r (keeps manual boards)	AVAILABLE
`gotourney results check <r>`	Check the results of round r	AVAILABLE
`gotourney standings [--round r]`	TGoR after each round → standings.ods	AVAILABLE
`gotourney wall`	Final wall list → wall_list.ods	AVAILABLE
`gotourney h9 [-o file]`	EGD result file from wall_list.ods	AVAILABLE
`gotourney version`	Show the version	AVAILABLE

All commands accept `--help`, for example `gotourney players add --help`.